

Saracoff Sentinel / Team Tijuana

December 2004

Glory to God in the Highest!

"Isn't it obvious that God deliberately chose men and women that the culture overlooks and exploits and abuses ... 'nobodies' to expose the hollow pretensions of the 'somebodies'?"
I Corinthians 1:27-30
(The Message)



God chose unlikely, lowly people that first Christmas —peasants to parent Jesus, shepherds to first behold God's glory in a manger. We have the honor of working among a similar group of "gente humilde" in Mexico. Some of their God-glorifying stories follow.

Rehabilitation Men Use Their Skills for Christmas

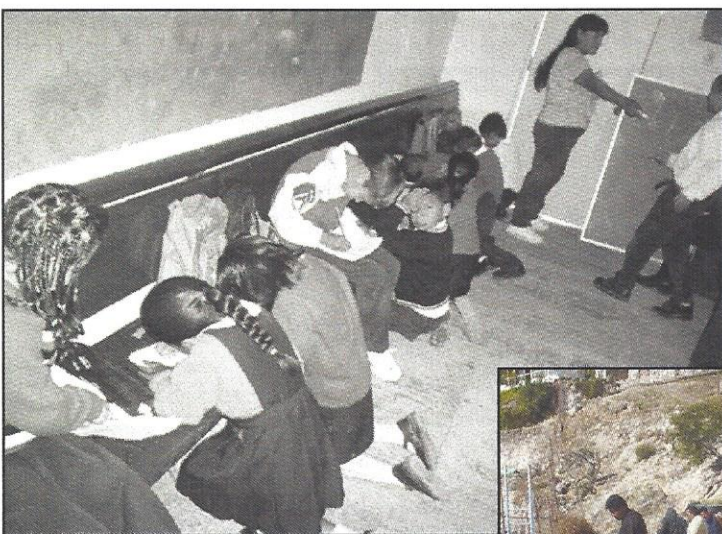


Victor Lozada, stained-glass master

If you enter some drug/alcohol rehabilitation programs in the United States or Mexico, you may find men watching TV or playing pool. If you enter the Esperanza Rehabilitation Center, you will find men working. Some are making cement blocks, others are welding or doing blacksmith stuff. The man in the photo is Victor. He works with a half dozen men teaching them to make products out of stained-glass.

The manger scene pictured is his latest successful product. We sold a good number of these manger scenes by word-of-mouth, but for these men to have steady work, a non-seasonal product is needed. If you have any ideas or know anyone who can help find a good model for a stained-glass picture frame, please let us know.

Along with work skills, the men are being disciplined. They covet your prayers. These are requests from four of them: **Fernando**—ability to read so he can read the Bible and never lose the joy. **Javier**—restoration in the Lord and future after rehab. **Roberto**—security in Christ to preach good news to the lost. **Aurelio**—that the work of his hands & his words will build others up and glorify God.



School Addition Takes Shape

We thank God for the various work groups who have helped build three desperately needed classrooms. Our friends who did the golf tournament did the main framing, alongside Manuel and the ground crew at La Roca. A church in Ukiah sent windows, other churches have sent teams to install insulation and sheet rock. It's a picture of the Body of Christ working together for His glory!



With the near completion of the school, La Roca faces an additional challenge. Tremendous erosion is taking away the side of the hill just feet from the new addition. Please pray that we can find an adequate solution and the necessary resources... soon!

School in the Church?

La Roca's free school has ministered to poor children in the Grupo valley for over 10 years. Because of poverty or lack of a birth certificate, they aren't able to go to the Mexican public schools. The attendance usually runs around 100 children grades K-6. Enrollment is now up to 180 children! Chela (standing above) is one of the new teachers helping with the overflow. The church became a temporary classroom; kids used the pews as desks.



A Christmas Project for the Elderly

Would you like to help us bring joy to the Casa Hogar for the elderly? Over 60 men and women live there, 20 volunteers from Pastor Chuy's church help out and they have kids!

My 90-year-old friend Maud has a burden for the elderly in Mexico. Her goal is to sew Christmas stockings (filled with practical things like socks, hand cream, gloves, chocolate and candy canes) to give to about 120 people on the Day of the Kings (Jan 6). But Maud can't do this alone. Can you sew or give a gift to help stuff those stockings?

FROM DUST TO DUST

A Mexican funeral for the poor is not sugar-coated. As we stood on fresh mounds of dirt that were covered with decaying flowers, the bull-dozer waited for our simple service for Luis to end so it could push the dirt over the casket. Hermano Luis, one of the Lord's humble servants from the Home for the Elderly, died unexpectedly a few weeks ago. His widow, Hermana Maria Batalla (and cook at the Home), sang at his graveside "Solo Dios hace el hombre feliz" (only God makes a person happy). In the midst of her grief, she shared the joy of knowing Jesus and knowing that Luis is with his Lord.

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We invite you to visit:
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Let us hear from you!

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